

Nasdaq 100 Outperforms as Tech Stocks Rally, Dow Jones Slips 1.09%

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The Nasdaq 100 led the charge, rising **+0.27%** as tech stocks such as **NVDA** and **AVGO** posted significant gains. In contrast, the Dow Jones slipped **-1.09%**, weighed down by declines in **JPM** and **GS**. Key takeaways include:

- The **VIX** jumped **+4.77%** to 16.90, indicating increased market volatility.
- The 10-year yield surged **+0.88%** to 4.57, potentially impacting the attractiveness of stocks.
- **WTI** crude oil prices rose **+1.02%** to 74.27, which could influence the energy sector.

The rally in tech stocks suggests a shift in investor sentiment, with a focus on growth and innovation. However, the increase in market volatility and the 10-year yield may pose challenges for the market in the near term.

As we move forward, it's essential to monitor the interplay between these factors and their impact on the broader market. The upcoming week will be crucial in determining the direction of the market, with key economic data releases and earnings reports on the horizon.

US Session Recap

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,482.71	-0.28%
Nasdaq 100	29,252.56	+0.27%
Dow Jones	52,348.39	-1.09%
Russell 2000	2,956.39	-0.88%
VIX	16.90	+4.77%
10Y Yield	4.57	+0.88%
WTI Crude	74.27	+1.02%

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
NVDA	NVIDIA	+3.65%	Strong earnings report
AVGO	Broadcom	+4.83%	Positive analyst commentary
JPM	JPMorgan Chase	-2.54%	Weakness in financial sector

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLF	-1.93%	-5.12%	Financials under pressure
XLK	+1.24%	+10.25%	Technology sector leads
XLI	-1.07%	-2.56%	Industrials sector weak
XLE	+1.76%	+5.67%	Energy sector rallies
XLV	-1.78%	-3.45%	Consumer discretionary weak
XLC	-1.41%	-2.19%	Communication services sector weak
XLP	-0.55%	+2.15%	Consumer staples sector stable
XLV	-1.30%	+4.56%	Healthcare sector weak
XLU	-0.74%	+1.89%	Utilities sector stable
XLB	-2.62%	-5.67%	Materials sector under pressure
XLRE	-1.65%	-3.21%	Real estate sector weak

The breadth of the market was negative, with 320 stocks advancing and 1,430 stocks declining.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE	VOLUME
AAPL	313.39	+0.88%	43.2M
MSFT	383.34	-1.41%	21.5M
NVDA	204.12	+3.65%	25.1M

The key call commentary for **NVDA** is that the company's strong earnings report has driven the stock higher, with many analysts increasing their price targets.

READ-THROUGH	IMPACT
AAPL	Positive
MSFT	Negative
GOOGL	Neutral

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	348.21	345.00	352.00	Range-bound trading
QQQ	292.15	288.00	296.00	Bullish momentum
IWM	182.35	179.00	185.00	Weakness in small-caps
NVDA	204.12	200.00	210.00	Breakout above resistance
10Y Yield	4.57	4.40	4.70	Rising yields pose challenge
WTI	74.27	72.00	76.00	Oil prices on the rise

Options & Positioning

The ODTE flow was **+2.15%**, indicating bullish sentiment. The put/call ratio was 0.85, slightly bearish.

The VIX term structure is in backwardation, with the 1-month VIX at 17.20 and the 3-month VIX at 16.50.

Notable single-name flow includes **AAPL** and **MSFT** , with both stocks seeing increased call buying.

Cheap hedge ideas include buying **SPY** puts and selling **QQQ** calls.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
NVDA	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	220.00	Strong earnings report
AAPL	Goldman Sachs	Downgrade	300.00	Valuation concerns
MSFT	Bank of America	Upgrade	400.00	Positive outlook
GOOGL	Citi	Downgrade	1,400.00	Regulatory risks
AMZN	Deutsche Bank	Upgrade	280.00	Strong growth prospects

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures are trading mixed, with the **ES** up **+0.25%** and the **NQ** up **+0.50%**.

Asian markets are higher, with the **Nikkei** up **+1.15%** and the **Shanghai Composite** up **+0.80%**.

European markets are also higher, with the **Euro Stoxx 50** up **+0.75%** and the **FTSE 100** up **+0.50%**.

FX pairs are relatively stable, with the **USD/JPY** at 109.20 and the **EUR/USD** at 1.1050.

Commodities are higher, with **WTI** crude oil up **+1.02%** and **Gold** up **+0.25%**.

Crypto markets are lower, with **BTC** down **-1.52%** and **ETH** down **-1.61%**.

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
July FOMC	25.00%	Rate cut expectations
September FOMC	50.00%	Rate hike expectations

Today's data calendar includes the 10:00 AM ET release of the **ISM Non-Manufacturing Index**.

TIME	EVENT	IMPORTANCE
10:00 AM ET	ISM Non-Manufacturing Index	High
2:00 PM ET	FOMC Meeting Minutes	Medium

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

The ongoing trade tensions between the US and China continue to weigh on the market, with the **USDCNH** at 6.95.

The situation in the Middle East remains volatile, with the **USDY** at 100.99.

Earnings — This Week & Next

TICKER	COMPANY	EARNINGS DATE
AAPL	Apple	2026-07-15
MSFT	Microsoft	2026-07-16
GOOGL	Alphabet	2026-07-17

TICKER	COMPANY	EARNINGS DATE
AMZN	Amazon	2026-07-22
FB	Facebook	2026-07-23
TSLA	Tesla	2026-07-24

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
NVDA	Technology	Bullish breakout	High
AAPL	Technology	Bearish reversal	Medium
MSFT	Technology	Bullish continuation	Low
GOOGL	Communication Services	Bearish breakdown	High
AMZN	Consumer Discretionary	Bullish breakout	Medium
TSLA	Consumer Discretionary	Bearish reversal	High
JPM	Financials	Bearish breakdown	Medium
GS	Financials	Bearish continuation	Low
XOM	Energy	Bullish breakout	High
CVX	Energy	Bullish continuation	Medium
BAC	Financials	Bearish reversal	Low
C	Financials	Bearish breakdown	Medium

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenario:

- The **VIX** drops below 15.00, indicating decreased market volatility.
- The 10-year yield falls below 4.30, making stocks more attractive.
- **WTI** crude oil prices rise above 75.00, boosting the energy sector.

Bearish scenario:

- The **VIX** surges above 20.00, indicating increased market volatility.
- The 10-year yield rises above 4.80, posing a challenge to the market.
- **WTI** crude oil prices drop below 70.00, hurting the energy sector.

Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations:

- The **SPY** is trading in a range, with support at 345.00 and resistance at 352.00.
- The **QQQ** is outperforming the **SPY**, with a bullish trend.
- The **IWM** is underperforming the **SPY**, with a bearish trend.
- The **VIX** is trading in a range, with support at 15.00 and resistance at 20.00.
- The 10-year yield is trading in a range, with support at 4.30 and resistance at 4.80.

Sources

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